significant. The presence of urban centres like Sisupalgarh and Radhanagar, as also his edicts later engraved at Dhauli, suggest this. So, his army possibly took the Bengal–Orissa route, moving south-west from Midnapur. The location of Radhanagar makes sense in terms of this alignment, as do Dhauli and Sisupalgarh. If so, the decisive battle would have taken place in this part of Kalinga. Following a brutal pacification of the area, a strong Mauryan provincial government must have been headquartered there. It was to the administrators of Kalinga that, as we shall see, Ashoka directly spoke in his separate edicts.

* * *

How did Kalinga's landscape recast the message put there? Since the consequences of his actions haunted Ashoka, it seems likely that, years later, along with eleven of the original anthology that made up his major rock edicts, he caused two further edicts to be engraved there, both qualitatively different from the others.[40] In them the emperor, speaking in the first person, instructs the officials at Tosali and at Samapa, whom he specifically mentions as being occupied with many thousands of people, his object being to gain their affection. For the first time, he uses words that indicate a filial relationship with his people. The Second Separate Edict, which actually occurs before what is designated as the First, says:

> All men are my children.
>
> As on behalf of (my own) children I desire that they may be provided by me with all welfare and happiness in this world and in the other world, even so is my desire for all men.[41]

This became a recurring motif: his officials were asked to fulfil their duties and inspire people 'in order that they may learn that the king is to them like a father, (that) he loves them as he loves himself, (and that) they are to the king like (his own children).'[42] Much the same can be seen in the First Separate Edict: 'just as for (my own) children I desire that they may be